

Mandate Clarity Framework

Maps where authority is real, assumed, fragmented, or absent.

DECISION DOMAIN (ONE SENTENCE DEFINING SCOPE)

AUTHORITY MAP

FORMAL AUTHORITY

Documented, approved, legally valid

ACTUAL AUTHORITY

Who makes the decision in practice

SPONSOR AUTHORITY

Who funds, backs, or enables this domain

CONTESTED / SHADOW

Overlapping claims, undocumented power

LAST FORMAL MANDATE REVIEW (DATE)

MISMATCH BETWEEN FORMAL AND ACTUAL (DESCRIBE)

PAGE 2 — CHALLENGE: FORCING QUESTIONS

Mandate Sub-Scores

Score each block 0–25. Answer every question honestly. Total = Mandate Clarity Score (0–100).

A. FORMAL AUTHORITY CLARITY (0–25)

Is the decision owner documented in writing?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Does the owner have budget authority matching the decision scope?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Is the mandate current (reviewed within 12 months)?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Does the owner know they own this decision?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Would a new hire be able to find this mandate in writing?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

A. SUB-SCORE

B. ACTUAL DECISION BEHAVIOUR (0–25)

In the last 3 decisions, who actually decided?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Did the documented owner make the call, or was it someone else?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Were any decisions made by default (inaction = decision)?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Is there a pattern of decisions being escalated unnecessarily?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

B. SUB-SCORE

C. ESCALATION COHERENCE (0–25)

Is the escalation path from this decision domain documented?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Has the escalation path been used successfully in the last 6 months?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Is there a defined trigger for when escalation is appropriate?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Does the escalation target accept escalations from this domain?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

C. SUB-SCORE

D. CONTESTED / SHADOW AUTHORITY LOAD (0–25)

Are there two or more people who believe they own this decision?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Has anyone exercised authority in this domain without formal mandate?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Are there approval bottlenecks that add unofficial veto power?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

Is there a stakeholder whose informal influence overrides the formal owner?

Y ☐ N ☐ P ☐

D. SUB-SCORE

PAGE 3 — CLASSIFY THE MANDATE

Mandate Classification

TOTAL MANDATE CLARITY SCORE (A + B + C + D)

CLEAR

Score: 75–100

Corrective path: Maintain current structure. Schedule quarterly review.

FRAGMENTED

Score: 50–74

Corrective path: Consolidate ownership. Eliminate overlapping mandates. Document escalation. Review in 60 days.

DELAYED

Score: 25–49

Corrective path: Remove approval bottlenecks. Accelerate mandate documentation. Escalate to sponsor for resolution. Review in 30 days.

ABSENT

Score: 0–24

Corrective path: Immediate mandate assignment required. Escalate to board/sponsor. No decisions in this domain until ownership is resolved.

RECOMMENDED REVIEW CADENCE

CLEAR = Quarterly | FRAGMENTED = 60 days | DELAYED = 30 days | ABSENT = Immediate reset

Friction Detection

Overlapping Mandate

Two or more parties claim decision ownership in the same domain.

PRESENT ☐ ABSENT ☐

INSTANCE (DESCRIBE)

IMPACT ON DECISION QUALITY

Absent Mandate

No one formally owns this decision. It is made by default or crisis.

PRESENT ☐ ABSENT ☐

INSTANCE (DESCRIBE)

IMPACT ON DECISION QUALITY

Shadow Authority

Someone exercises power without documented authority.

PRESENT ☐ ABSENT ☐

INSTANCE (DESCRIBE)

IMPACT ON DECISION QUALITY

Approval Bottleneck

Decision requires sign-off that creates structural delay.

PRESENT ☐ ABSENT ☐

INSTANCE (DESCRIBE)

IMPACT ON DECISION QUALITY

Mandate Clarity Output

MANDATE CLASSIFICATION (CLEAR / FRAGMENTED / DELAYED / ABSENT)
MANDATE CLARITY SCORE (0–100)
STRUCTURAL IMPLICATION
CORRECTIVE NEXT MOVE
REVIEW CADENCE (QUARTERLY / 60D / 30D / IMMEDIATE)
ESCALATION RISK

“Most organisations do not lack leadership. They lack clean authority.”

Feeds into Executive Reporting: Authority Scope, Sponsor/Board Section, Decision Logic, Strategy Qualification.

SYSTEM TRANSITION

If this condition is confirmed, move to Executive Reporting (£95) to price consequence and formalise next action.

If intervention is already justified, move to Strategy Room (£395).

First use: Complete authority map (page 1), answer forcing questions (page 2), classify (page 3), diagnose frictions (page 4), record output (page 5).